



YouTube finally takes action

YouTube finally decides to take action and ban intentionally disturbing 'kids' videos.
<https://digit.in/sep19-80>



US Air Force's secret space plane

The Air Force's secret space plane has set a new record: 718 days in orbit.
<https://digit.in/sep19-81>

BUYING ADVICE

BUDGET SMART BANDS

Q Hi,
 I have been reading Digit for about a year and I love it and it is the best. I am always excited for it to come. I just wanted to know a good Samsung smartwatch under ₹2500.

—Tejas Tewani



Xiaomi Mi Band 3

A Hey Tejas,
 None of the Samsung Smartwatches are available at such a low price. In fact, you'll be hard pressed to get any smartwatch in this price

segment. You can get smart bands or fitness trackers such as the Mi Band 3 which cost about ₹1,999/- and do tell the time. There's also the Honor Band 4 that starts from ₹2,599 which might be what you're looking for.

A LAPTOP FOR COLLEGE

Q Dear agent001,
 I am Vimal Panara, studying civil engineering. I used to read Digit every month and it is an extraordinary magazine. I wanted to get advice for buying a new laptop.

I want to buy a laptop under ₹55,000 for study purpose (gaming laptop will also work). All software, which are being used by civil engineers (such as AutoCAD) should work properly without lag. I have seen a laptop on Amazon but it has combination of NVIDIA GTX 1050 4GB graphics card with Ryzen 5 2500u processor. I don't know whether this combination will work or not, as it has 'u' variant of processor with a high-end graphics card.

Please suggest which laptop should I buy. Thanks in advance.

—Vimal Panara



A Hey Vimal,
 There's no problem with the u-series processor working with the GTX

1050 graphics card. You will however, face issues with regards to performance in most of your CAD applications. For CAD applications, you need to check the website of the particular software to figure out which of the GPUs are certified to run without any issues. From an architectural perspective, if one of the GPUs from a series of cards is supported, then the entire series should work without any issues but there are instances wherein the software doesn't recognise a card simply because the device ID has not been included in the software. Ideally, you should prepare a list of all the software that are critical for your work and then go about checking which GPUs are certified across all of them and then figure out your options.

With regards to performance, most CAD applications love to get more cores. There are specific workstation machines with workstation grade GPUs but they're going to be a lot more expensive than 55K. The Intel H-series processors and AMD H-mobile processors start



ASUS TUF FX505DT

around 60K, so at most you can only get the Core i5 9300H and AMD Ryzen 5-3550H based machines in your budget. Check out the ASUS TUF FX505DT, which is the closest we could find to meet your requirements.

EXTERNAL DRIVES

Q Hey Agent001,
 I'm looking forward to buy an external HDD, mainly for backup purposes. I'm not much aware of the things that should be taken into account while buying an external drive



Samsung T5

so it would be really great if you could help me out.

A 1TB drive should be enough for me but if the price difference between 1TB and 2TB isn't much than I can go for 2TB. Please suggest for both if possible.

—Sagar Khatri



A Hey Sagar,
 With external drives, you need to figure out the parameters based on whether:

1. You want portability i.e. no power socket
2. Cushioning for rough usage
3. Speed. HDD vs SSD
4. Software features such as cloud storage + encryption

Portable drives that have SSDs or mobile HDDs are portable and the SSD is obviously faster but a bit more expensive. Hard drives are less tolerant to shocks but you can get drives such as the ADATA Rugged or the LaCie Rugged drives which have silicon cushioning on the outside as well as on the inside. Though they're still not as shock-tolerant as SSDs. The price difference between rugged and non-rugged drives would be about 400 bucks in the case of hard drives. External SSDs, on the other hand cost over 3x more than external HDDs. The Samsung T5 costs ₹15K and the Seagate 1TB SSD costs approximately ₹16K. As for encryption, you can have third-party software to encrypt your drives. Should you go for drives with hardware encryption support then you can forget about data recovery should there be any problems because you need to find a replacement chip with the exact same encryption key, which is practically impossible.